

Chapter 1 - Death

The early May sunshine was so dazzling and warm, but inside the VIP ward of a famous neurology hospital abroad, a family with hearts ashen as death was gathered.

Feng Yue lay in the hospital bed wearing an oxygen mask, her once thick black hair having long since fallen out from repeated rounds of chemotherapy.

Feng Yue's gaze was already somewhat unfocused, but she still stared unblinkingly at the branch on the tree outside the window that had just sprouted green buds, as if waiting for something.

The ward was very quiet. She knew her family members were outside listening to the doctor delivering her final death notice.

Feng Yue had never imagined her life would be so short—she was only 26 years old this year.

And the time wasted on Yan Lin¹ had occupied nearly half of her life.

She suddenly felt there were still so many things she hadn't done—she hadn't traveled with her parents, hadn't participated in a single gathering with friends, hadn't raised a little cat that she loved most.

In her life, all that remained was just Yan Lin, that person she had loved for twelve years.

Today was her last day in this world, and she hadn't expected that Yan Lin wouldn't care about her life or death at all, not even feeling it necessary to see her one last time.

At the thought of Yan Lin, Feng Yue's eyes began to moisten.

She didn't want to be like this either. She also hoped to leave her family with a beautiful image during her final moments.

Feng Yue took a deep breath, then reached out and pulled out the IV tube from the back of her hand. Without the real-time delivery of cold liquid, she even vaguely felt that her hand seemed to warm up a little.

Father Feng and Mother Feng wiped away their tears and pushed open the door, seeing Feng Yue pulling out the IV tube. Mother Feng, who was already unable to control her emotions, became even more distraught and threw herself beside Feng Yue.

"Nuan nuan², don't do this, don't do this!" Mother Feng's emotions were almost completely broken. "Let's change hospitals! Let's change hospitals and we'll definitely be able to cure this!"

Feng Yue reached out to touch her mother's cheek, wiping away her tears, and said with a slight smile: "Mom, I'm fine. Let me be comfortable." Let me leave comfortably.

Seeing this, Father Feng also reddened his eyes. This man who had dominated the business world his entire life couldn't say a word when facing his dying daughter.

Father Feng stepped forward to help his wife up, holding back tears as he comforted his daughter: "Nuan nuan, don't be afraid. Everything will be fine, it's okay, it's okay."

In fact, everyone knew that when they entered at this moment, they had come to accompany Feng Yue through what remained of her life.

At this moment, besides the Feng family of three in the ward, there was also a couple standing nearby—those were Yan Lin's parents. After Feng Yue and Yan Lin married, they were naturally also Feng Yue's parents.

This couple also looked grief-stricken, but they also carried another emotion.

That was guilt.

Their daughter Yan Lin, as Feng Yue's legal spouse, was not present in the ward at this time. This made them feel deeply ashamed.

Seeing Feng Yue occasionally glance toward the ward door, Mother Yan's heart ached.

She composed her emotions and forced a smile as she walked to Feng Yue's bedside.

"Little Yue, we've already contacted A-Lin. She's on her way here and will arrive soon. Don't worry."

Feng Yue really liked Mother Yan, so she couldn't possibly vent her dissatisfaction and grievances about Yan Lin on her.

Speaking was too tiring for Feng Yue, so she just struggled to reach her hand under her pillow.

"Mom, please give this to her. I might not have this chance anymore."

Mother Yan looked at the envelope in her hand. It was just an ordinary envelope with the words "Twelve" written on it in Feng Yue's handwriting.

Mother Yan held the envelope sadly, and at this moment, she couldn't help but blame her own daughter in her heart.

The two mothers sat on either side of Feng Yue's bed. Feng Yue used her slightly warm hand to touch Mother Feng's cheek.

However, this action was a bit too strenuous for her. Her hand began to tremble uncontrollably, and her mind was hit with a violent stabbing pain.

The machine that had been maintaining Feng Yue's life emitted a piercing warning sound, and the doctors and nurses who had been waiting outside rushed in.

They separated her relatives and began the final resuscitation efforts.

Heart-wrenching wails, the shrieking of machines, the calm commands of doctors and nurses—all of this rang chaotically in Feng Yue's ears.

She was so tired. She wanted to sleep...

But just then, as if she were hallucinating, she caught the sound of running footsteps from the corridor outside the ward.

That sound was very familiar—it was a sound she had heard for twelve years.

Feng Yue really wanted to open her eyes and see Yan Lin one last time, but heaven seemed to dislike her so much that it wouldn't even grant her such a small wish.

She really couldn't wait for Yan Lin anymore...

A sharp "beep—" sounded, and the ECG representing her heartbeat became a flat line without any fluctuations.

The doctor's calm and cold voice rang out in the noisy ward: "Patient Feng Yue, late-stage brain cancer, resuscitation failed, deceased. Time of death: May 4th, 9:47 AM."

Yan Lin had just stepped into the ward when she heard this sentence and saw the pale, lifeless person lying on the hospital bed.

She didn't get to see her one last time.

Feng Yue had left her forever.

Darkness quickly engulfed Feng Yue. She didn't know how much time had passed when her consciousness gradually returned. In a space of complete blackness, a blue light suddenly appeared, and then she was uncontrollably drawn toward that light.

Feng Yue was soon surrounded by that blue light, the piercing brightness making it difficult for her to open her eyes.

She didn't understand why she had suddenly appeared here. She was certain she had died.

Could this be heaven or hell?

Feng Yue tentatively opened her eyes. The blue light dimmed, and what appeared before her was a light blue space with a not-very-thick book floating not far in front of her.

Feng Yue stretched out her hands to look at them—rosy and fair, unlike her hands during her illness.

And moreover...

Feng Yue reached up to twist a strand of hair hanging in front of her chest—lustrous and smooth. She felt like it had been a long time since she had seen herself with hair.

Feng Yue composed her emotions before walking toward the book.

She tentatively reached out to touch the book. The light around it dimmed, and then the title on the cover appeared before Feng Yue's eyes.

This "Lin"...

Feng Yue had a bad premonition in her heart, and then she opened the book with trepidation.

"The meeting between Yan Lin and Chu An'an took place in the fourth year after Yan Lin became widowed..."

Then Feng Yue read through it like reading a novel, page after page.

It turned out that she, Feng Yue, was nothing more than a character in a novel, and moreover, a supporting character who died upon appearance.

And the main character of the story was Yan Lin, her wife Yan Lin.

As for the other main character, Chu An'an, Feng Yue didn't recognize her.

Feng Yue closed the book with complicated feelings. Before she could figure things out, her mind was hit with a severe pain, more painful than when her illness flared up.

It seemed this time she was truly going to die.

When Feng Yue woke up again, she only felt herself lying on a hard floor, with a faint stabbing pain in her temples.

She struggled to open her eyes, and what she saw were familiar lighting fixtures and room decorations.

This was their room.

After Feng Yue and Yan Lin married, they had moved out to live together, purchasing a property near the Yan Group company building as their new home, to make it convenient for Yan Lin to go to work.

Every detail of the house's decoration had been personally overseen by Feng Yue at the time. Back then, she thought she and Yan Lin would always live here together.

She never expected that she would live in this house for less than two years.

She looked around and confirmed once again that this was indeed her and Yan Lin's room. So how had she returned here now?

Wasn't she dead?

Feng Yue sat up from the floor and then collapsed onto the bed as if drained of strength.

She had experienced too many things in one day.

First her own death, then inexplicably reading a strange novel, and then somehow returning home.

Feng Yue lay on her back on the bed to recover, then sat up to see if there was anything useful around.

Her glance naturally fell on the phone placed on the bedside table. She picked up the phone, and when the lock screen lit up, what appeared before her eyes was today's date.

July 4th, 12:50 AM—the day after their first wedding anniversary.

How had she suddenly returned to a year ago?

Feng Yue's mind was in chaos, and memories that had been sealed away began to slowly resurface.

She remembered that this day was the first time she and Yan Lin had a major fight, on their first wedding anniversary.

She remembered that day she had started preparing from morning—clothes, makeup, accessories, and even their dinner. There wasn't a single thing that Feng Yue hadn't prepared with care.

But what she had waited for was a bouquet of roses she didn't like and Yan Lin's coldly indifferent questioning.

Feng Yue gripped the phone and calmed down. She thought she had long forgotten this experience, but she had only sealed it away in the deepest part of her memory.

If she remembered correctly, after this fight, the two of them had fallen into a cold war. Yan Lin had gone on a business trip abroad for a month, during which they had no contact at all.

In her memory, Yan Lin hadn't come to say a word to her that night, much less comfort her, because she was preparing for a 6 AM flight the next day, so Yan Lin had slept in the guest room.

Feng Yue looked at the time and prepared to see if her guess was correct. She wanted to know if she had really returned to the past.

At this time, Yan Lin had already gone to sleep. She had the key to the guest room.

So a few minutes later, Feng Yue's figure appeared in front of the guest room door on the first floor, holding a set of keys, one of which was for the guest room.

Feng Yue lowered her head to look at her feet. Actually, she didn't need to go look.

The scene in the nearby dining room could already explain everything.

Rose petals scattered all over the floor, a table of completely cold food—all of this clearly showed what had just happened here.

She really had returned to a year ago.

¹ Yan Lin (严霖) - The protagonist's name. "Yan" is a common Chinese surname meaning "strict" or "stern," and "Lin" means "continuous rain" or "drizzle."

² Nuan nuan (囡囡) - An affectionate nickname meaning "little daughter" or "darling girl," commonly used by parents in Shanghai and surrounding regions.

³ An Lin Wang Shi (安霖往事) - The title of the novel within the novel. "An" refers to Chu An'an's surname, "Lin" refers to Yan Lin, and "Wang Shi" means "past affairs" or "bygone matters."